

GoldenHour

Environment & Configuration Template

Backend configuration guide for local and production deployment

1. Environment File Template (.env)

Create a file named .env in the root of the goldenhour-backend folder. Never commit this file to GitHub.

```
# Database Configuration DB_HOST=localhost
DB_USER=root DB_PASSWORD=your_mysql_password_here DB_NAME=goldenhour
DB_PORT=3306 # Authentication
JWT_SECRET=goldenhour_secret_key_change_this_in_production # Server
PORT=5000
```

2. Variable Descriptions

Variable	Description	Example Value
DB_HOST	MySQL server hostname	localhost
DB_USER	MySQL username	root
DB_PASSWORD	MySQL password set during install	your_password
DB_NAME	Database name (auto-created by schema.sql)	goldenhour
DB_PORT	MySQL port (default 3306)	3306
JWT_SECRET	Secret key for signing JWT tokens	change_this_in_production
PORT	Port the backend server listens on	5000

3. Setup Steps

Step 1 — Copy the template above into a new file called .env

Step 2 — Replace your_mysql_password_here with your actual MySQL root password

Step 3 — Change JWT_SECRET to a long random string in production

Step 4 — Save the file in the root of goldenhour-backend folder

Step 5 — Run npm run dev — the server reads all values from .env automatically

4. Production Configuration (Railway)

For cloud deployment on Railway.app, set these environment variables in the Railway dashboard under the Variables tab:

Variable	Where to get it
DB_HOST	Provided by Railway MySQL plugin automatically
DB_USER	Provided by Railway MySQL plugin automatically
DB_PASSWORD	Provided by Railway MySQL plugin automatically
DB_NAME	Provided by Railway MySQL plugin automatically
DB_PORT	Provided by Railway MySQL plugin automatically
JWT_SECRET	Generate a random 32+ character string
PORT	Railway sets this automatically — can omit

5. Security Notes

NEVER commit `.env` to GitHub — it contains your database password and JWT secret.

The `.gitignore` file already excludes `.env` from version control.

Use a strong random `JWT_SECRET` in production — minimum 32 characters.

Change the default MySQL root password before deploying to production.

6. .gitignore Template

The following `.gitignore` file is included in the repository:

```
node_modules/ .env *.log .DS_Store
```